Module 16: Capstone Systems Synthesis - Learning Questions

1. How can a molecular change affect an ecosystem?
2. Why does scale matter in biological explanation?
3. What is a mechanism chain?
4. How can feedback limit or amplify change?
5. Why are tradeoffs common in biology?
6. How do constraints shape biological systems?
7. What evidence belongs at molecular, organismal, or ecosystem scale?
8. How can a lab result support a capstone explanation?
9. How should an explanation change when evidence conflicts?
10. What makes a synthesis stronger than a list of facts?
11. A drought-tolerant plant variant becomes more common while herbivores decline. Build a proposed mechanism chain and give one alternative explanation for the herbivore decline.
12. Choose one link in your chain. Specify a comparison, a measurement, and a result that would make you revise that link.